

NOVEMBER 1974



UP FROM THE PITS!

NEW BLUE BOX INFO

Yes, after 6 months in the pits we're back! Our unannounced vacation took place for several reasons the main one being a shortage of help and a surplus of work. By now we have sold alot of back issues & the Income has helped to put us solidly in the black.

We will try to come out fairly regularly from now on, but this depends also on reader contributions & printing costs. We are also planning a 1975 Convention and need ideas for the convention from everyone. Possibly contests and exhibits and such. Please write to us if you've got suggestions.

In addition, we will be having technical seminars as always. If you are well-versed in any phase of phreaking covered in TAP or otherwise, please get in touch with us to teach at the convention.

Dear TAP,
Checking the guide to Subversive Organizations and Publications (House document 398) I noticed the absence of TAP or YIPL-Then I noticed the date was 1961. Did you make the new list?

Anyway, tell your readers that it's illegal to remove the dialing instruction plate on payphones (below dial) if they were planning on using a high carbon bit on a hand drill to drill a hole exactly

2 3/4" to the right and 5/8" down.

Not only is it illegal, but if

someone were to accidentally poke the end of a paperclip through the hole, it would do all sorts of terrible things like releasing all the money they had just put in to make a long distance call, preventing them from supporting the wonderful phone company. (Note- drill will cut through cast iron case, though not steel lock or coin box.)

-NEW YORK-

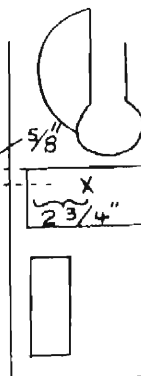
-And the dialing instruction plate could be put back in, obscuring the hole and allowing nefarious individuals to continue their plundering-TAP.

Dear TAP,
On a recent trip to Paris I was able to make free calls to any point in the U.S. (except Hawaii) and Europe from a special yellow public telephone booth situated all over Paris called "Interurbain". The only catch was that the called party had to be muted otherwise a loud tone makes conversation impossible. As you know, the mute prevents supervision, on overseas trunks this is accomplished by sending 2400 Hz to the calling party C.O., indicating that the called party has answered. It is the lack of the 2400 Hz tone which prevents the loud blocking tone from coming on the Paris phone.

Wait for dial tone, dial 19, wait for a second dial tone, then dial 1 + area code + number. I tried to off a 800 or 555 number, but you can't dial them nor off any number for that matter with an SF. I'm

not sure, but you might be able to do this from other European cities. I believe that the black box is international, since most European telephone systems are still step or crossbar.

-NEW YORK-



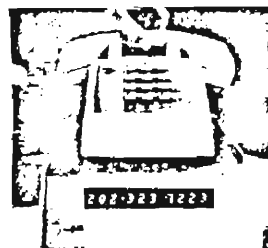
We've gotten feedback on the New Blue Box Circuit (Issue 26). One problem of the circuit is that all the diodes for one frequency must be matched. The Motorola Silicon dual diode MSD 6150 (common anode) saves PC board space and is a matched pair. 25¢ each in 100 quantity. If regular diodes are to be used, use only silicon. Though we said germanium diodes are ok, they usually have too much leakage current and the pots will cross-affect each other.

In fact, you can eliminate the hassle and matching of diodes altogether by using double-pole push-buttons. Polypaks sells a \$6.88 General Telephone Data entry keyboard with 10 buttons. You'll need 2 more DPST and a SPST for 2000, but you'll save money on diodes. The same 10 trimpots are used. And keep the wiring to the pots and switches good and secure electrically. A loose connection is a changing frequency. We also have an unchecked report that eliminating diodes with double pole switches makes the regulator unnecessary.

Dear TAP,
As for picking Medeco and Keso locks you can forget it. Medeco is a sidebar type of lock like the Briggs and Stratton locks G.M. uses in their cars. Locksmiths usually use codes for auto locks as they can't pick them. A more efficient method for vending machines would be to use an awl & 5 lb. hammer to make a hole in the sheet metal of the cabinet and then a nibbling tool (for electronic construction) to enlarge the hole enough to reach in and disengage the lock cylinder from the locking bolts. The nibbler can be bought at Lafayette or Radio Shack but may not cut through all thicknesses of machine doors.

-COLORADO-

Dear TAP,
According to the N. E. T. news line, you people are breaking the state law of Mass. when you published the 1975 Credit Card Code. Upon conviction you can be fined \$2000 and get a year in the slammer. When I heard this I called the head of Security in Boston with a phoney c. c. number and told him what I was doing. Then I asked him what he was going to do about it. Was he ever pissed off. Yours in conspiracy-
Stainless Steel Rat



Device catches obscene callers and other phone criminals

A new system from Telident Inc. connects to any telephone and displays the incoming caller's number. Its purpose is to help catch obscene and other objectionable phone callers. The caller's number and exchange remain visible throughout the call; this pinpoints any phone being used for the obscene call, whether it's a private or pay phone. The maker says the system will also discourage those making bomb threats or ransom demands, if you are bothered with these problems.

Contact Telident, Inc., 304 S. Broadway, Los Angeles for information.

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Movement groups may reprint with TAP's address, and please send us a copy of reprinted work.

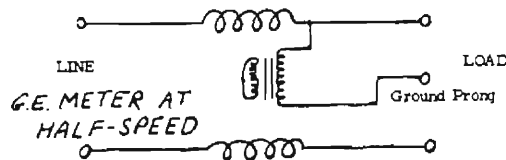
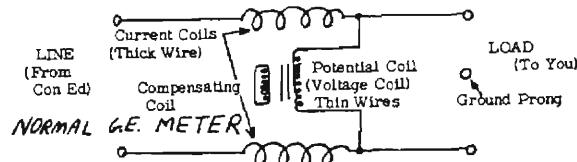
MORE FREE ELECTRICITY

Our article on Free Electricity prompted great reader response and we've got more info on how to do it. Several meters were sent to us and we've learned a lot about how they work.

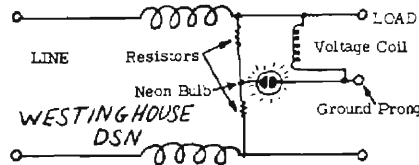
Several readers suggested that the speed-adjust screws do work but not very well and are sometimes labeled backwards to confuse Robb Hoods. However, we tested the New York standard meter which is a Westinghouse DSN, and found that the front screw was labeled correctly (F for Fast is counterclockwise) and could reduce the meter by 40%! And the screw on the side can make the meter start moving in the wrong direction if you turn it enough! These revelations are very encouraging indeed. The other meters also have adjustment screws, and one unmarked meter with large brown coils inside had 5 speed adjustment screws!

Most home meters are of the 220 volt dual-phase (3-wire) type which supplies 110 and 220 volts at the same time. There are two 110 volt "hot" wires that are out of phase with each other, which means that there is 220 volts between them, and there is a ground wire. From either hot wire to ground is 110 volts. One reader writes in that on the 220 volt, GE single phase meters, about a 50% reduction in rotor speed can be obtained by wiring the potential coil so it receives only 110 volts, not 220. The potential coil is the small coil wound out of thin wire & connected in shunt across the load side of the meter. This is accomplished as follows:

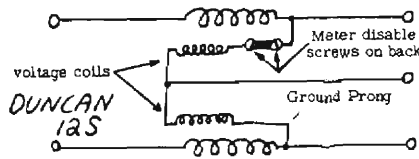
1. Remove meter from socket. (Issue 23)
2. Remove case from meter (usually unscrews).
3. Locate the 2 small wires that are connected to the two line terminals (bottom two terminals).
4. Disconnect either of these wires (but not both), from the line terminal it's attached to.
5. Connect it to the ground terminal. This is the smallest prong on the back of the meter and usually points a different way (like horizontal). Of course, you're connecting it not on the back of the meter, but on the inside of the back, as the ground terminal goes through the plastic back of the meter.
6. Get electric heat. It's cheaper!



Before doing this you should make sure that your meter has the same hookup as the GE meter used in the above letter. Some meters have a different hookup. For example, the Westinghouse DSN has a voltage coil across one side of the line and ground,



NORMALLY. So this can't be "Halved". The Duncan 12S has TWO voltage coils, one from each side of the line to ground. One controls the reading of your 110 volt appliances, and the other controls the reading of your 220 volt appliances. On this meter, the meter will have to be tested to see which voltage is controlled by the two screws on the back. Turn on a 220 volt appliance (with the screws loosened and the metal piece pulled out and see if the wheel turns faster. If it does, the screws control your 110 volt appliances. If not, then your air conditioner and other 220 volt units will only cost half as much.



We hear you

All the meters we tested have 5 prongs. 2 are the input, 2 are the output and 1 is ground. Disconnecting the ground stops the meter but leaves you with the lights on. Breaking off the pin and putting back the meter is good, but less suspicion will be aroused if you bend the prong (the ground prong is the odd one out of place from the others and pointed a different way) so that it doesn't go in its socket. In the Westinghouse meter they have a cute circuit to show whether this has been done. Disconnecting the ground or another wire makes a neon light in the meter glow, alerting the meter reader. If you have this type of meter, you can disconnect the bulb, or remove it and blow it out. Just make sure it looks like it's working but simply not lit. To blow out the bulb, hook it in series with a 500 ohm resistor of 10 watts or more to a wall socket and let it slowly burn itself out.

We're told that a GE type 1-80-S meter can be slowed down 4% (every little bit helps!) with the adjustment screw, but as in all meters, GENTLY! You don't want to damage the meter.

It's also been suggested that to remove the seals that hold the meter closed, just snip it as close to the plastic or lead part and bend the end over so that it will grip the inside of the hole again when it's re-used.

Another idea is to simply turn over the meter and it will run in reverse, unfortunately this is easy for a meterman to spot and is usually impossible with 5-prong meters which are the most common.

Most electric companies estimate your bill for several months and adjust it when the meter is actually read, which is less often than every month. It's good to know, however, when the man actually comes if your setup is slightly detectable. If he's on to you, does anyone know if it's legal to offer him

a present to keep it in the family? (Not for him, but for you. Let's hear from the lawyers out there.

Dear TAP, For your edification, I'm enclosing a photocopy of the current ITT Telex guide showing country codes. If you have access to a teleprinter, you can access the ITT system quite easily by dialing 710-589-3211. Dita Beard will welcome you. Many universities have time-sharing computer terminals that could be used. You know, I assume, that the code for TWX operators is 954-1212. You can dial most any big-city area code plus the code and get the operator.

More common than mail tampering is the MAIL WATCH. The postman delivers your mail—but he makes a record of the return address on every piece. Recommended: a Canadian post office box. Ever since Lee Harvey Oswald, America's Postmasters have required positive ID from prospective box renters. Not so in Canada, and the price is right—about \$10/yr. In small towns, Good for ordering reagents.

We understand that the British Post Office and Scotland Yard are now battling the SILVER BOX (also known as a 'bleep'). Inasmuch as out-of-band signaling is far more common than in-band class 5 types (cf. Japan, Australia, Europe) it is urgent that North American phreaks inform themselves on this subject. Other than info about prosecutions, nothing has been received so far. We are continuing to monitor all legal developments in phreaking on a regular basis. Of course black boxing should be easy even under an out-of-band system, but redirecting calls? And what codes would access overseas senders?

Re Con Ed: Happily I am far removed from them

these days. Telling them that you are a new tenant often doesn't work without a lease to prove it. You have to pretend to be the OLD tenant, and say you are moving. (Give any old address). That gets you off the hook; they transfer your account, especially if they already have a deposit. After the account is cleared up on the computer (remember, they use microfilm for their records, and it's several days behind) you can open your new account.

-CANADA-

Dear TAP,

A few years ago a friend and I were into faking the money dropping in old 3 slot payphones by using an old payphone top, containing the bell and gong for coin sounds. Thru operator responses, visiting the switchboards, and looking at coin collect mechanisms, I discovered that when handling a payphone call, a red light is lit on the operator's switchboard until the 1st coin drops. After that the light goes out and a green light goes on & stays on until money is collected or returned, when the green goes off & the red comes on again. The lights don't indicate if the money was collected or returned, just if a first coin was deposited, and whether the lever has returned to normal position after collect or return.

On some operator boards, they have a BV key. One operator told me that she was only told it was for computer access to dial Rate & Route, such as BV 009 ST, then KP-AC-XXN-XXN-1-ST (first XXN is desired exchange, second is calling exchange) to get the computer-generated voice. But BV can also get local verification, which the fuckheads didn't tell our operators. Is there an MF tone to the BV key? What is it? Does anyone know how to use the 700 + 1700 coin collect and 1100 + 1700 coin return tones?

-KANSAS-

YOU CAN HELP TAP

If you can contribute any information that you think others would be interested in, please do so. TAP readers are the main source of our information. You can help by meeting employees of phone and power companies, alarm places, etc., and asking them about questions other people raise in the newsletter. Be sure to get details and maintain contact in case you have additional questions. Most employees of those companies would be glad to screw their boss and they'd probably be interested in TAP, too. We hope that a lot of you will gather information so we know what the scene is around the country and Canada.

All information is free if you can't afford it. Let us know.

BACK ISSUES

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Dear TAP,
Thought I'd write and tell the rest of Phreakdom about a technique for tapping neighbor's phone lines that I used to use, for whatever it's worth. The problem with a direct tap is that sooner or later, some phone company type is going to come and check the line. To make it undetectable:

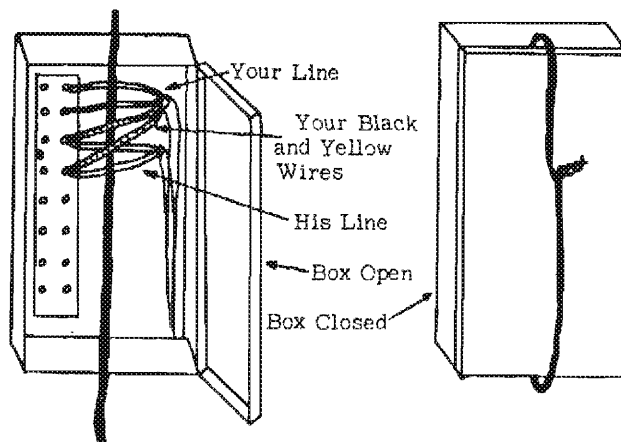
We are going to use the 2 spare wires of the 4-wire cable running to your phone (usually yellow & black). First locate your cable and the tappee's cable in the main box for your apartment. (A phone with clip leads will help). Then trim to length and strip the ends of the 2 wires. They should be just long enough to reach the terminals of the other phone with NO slack. The wires should then be attached to the terminals just loose enough so that they pull off easily. Straighten and strip some of the other cables' yellow and black wires too so that your's won't look different later. Then run a big wire (12 gauge house wire is fine) under your wires as shown. Close the box lid as tight as possible and twist the wire ends together as shown. Now when the box is opened the wires will be ripped loose. The Foneperson will not cut the outside wire before opening it up because the whole thing might fall apart. With a DPDT toggle switch (and line relays, recorders, etc.) you may now freely use the line. A BB will be safe and cause no charge to the other party's line-Ed.

I built the Red Box from your last issue and like it. The two diodes feeding the 500K pots for 5¢ and 10¢ aren't needed. I'm also doing research on bank machines and "money cards". If I can crack their code on the cards and rewrite them it could be good for \$1000 a day. I will appreciate any help on this (bank employees could really help).

-INDIANA-

Dear TAP,
"The best things in life are free, almost..." according to the Theta Cable TV ads in Los Angeles. On April 26 Theta introduced the "Z channel". You can watch first run movies for \$6.95 per month for the first TV and \$1.95 for each add'l TV, right? Wrong! Because if you want to watch the Z channel all you have to do is press the "2" and the "8" buttons on the channel selector at the same time. So don't forget, $2 + 8 = Z$. And it's free!

-THETA, The goddess of TV



Dear TAP,
Alabama Power has increased my line voltage from 115 to 130 volts. They won't lower the voltage (they claim it's impossible) and I have blown the flyback transformers on 2 TV sets. This voltage increase has also increased my electric bill by 27%. I know the Power Company is having difficulty but if they are going to raise their line voltage and cheat me into paying 27% more I'd like to cheat back. Here is the formula for computing your own power company's ripoff on you:

Power = Voltage X Current so if the voltage is upped the increase in power is:

$$\text{Power Increase} = \frac{(\text{New voltage})^2 - (\text{Old voltage})^2}{(\text{Old voltage})^2}$$

Multiply this by 100 to get the percentage increase.

So, All an electric company has to do for an Instant rate increase is step up the line voltage. My electric company has done this to me without regard for my appliances or my pocketbook. Any back issues that you have to help me outfox their meters will allow me to strike back.

-ALABAMA-

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TAP, ROOM 504, 152 W. 42 ST., NY, NY 10036

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Hot line cooled

LONDON (UPI) — "I'm a post office engineer," said the voice on the telephone to Mrs. Hannah O'Flaherty. "Your phone is in danger of overheating and bursting into flames. Place the handset in a bowl of water."

Mrs. O'Flaherty did so. Five hours later, a straight-faced official of the telephone exchange told her:

"Placing receivers in water is not, and never will be, an emergency repair technique."

THE STAR-LEDGER, Monday, March 25, 1974